

Tobias Großbölting

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of Mannheim

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Research Fields

Econometrics, Causal Inference

Doctoral Studies

University of Mannheim, CDSE

Sep. 2021 – June 2027 (Expected)

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Supervisors: Christoph Rothe and Paul Goldsmith-Pinkham

Yale University

2024 – 2025

Visiting Ph.D. Student.

Pre-doctoral Studies

Humboldt University of Berlin

2018 – 2021

M.Sc. Economics.

University of Copenhagen

2019

Visiting Student, Department of Economics.

Humboldt University of Berlin

2015 – 2018

B.Sc. Economics.

University of Warwick

2017 – 2018

Visiting Student, Department of Economics.

References

Christoph Rothe

University of Mannheim

c.rothe@uni-mannheim.de

Paul Goldsmith-Pinkham

Yale School of Management

paul.goldsmith-pinkham@yale.edu

Job Market Paper

Heterogeneous Groups and Covariate Adjustment in Regression Discontinuity Designs ([latest version](#))

Abstract *I study covariate adjustment in regression discontinuity designs with discrete covariates, such as education level, occupation, or gender, that partition the sample into subgroups with heterogeneous regression functions. The standard local-polynomial RD estimator pools observations across these heterogeneous groups, generating an additive pooling bias whenever group composition varies along the running variable. I show that covariate adjustment can eliminate this pooling bias from the leading term of the worst-case bias under a uniform asymptotic framework. Specifically, I propose the Stratified RD estimator, which avoids pooling through stratification: It first estimates group-specific treatment effects within each group and group weights at the cutoff and then forms a weighted average. I derive an explicit range of bandwidth choices under which the Stratified RD estimator achieves both weakly lower asymptotic variance and worst-case bias than the local-polynomial estimator, over a common smoothness class. These improvements yield shorter honest confidence intervals for the same target parameter. A placebo exercise using data from the Current Population Survey shows reductions in MSE of 8% to 33% and honest confidence intervals that are 6% to 16% shorter depending on sample sizes and bandwidths.*

Work in Progress

Spatial Regression Discontinuity Designs

joint with Soonwoo Kwon, Michael Pollmann and Aurel Rochell

Discretized Treatment Effect Heterogeneity in Regression Discontinuity Designs

joint with Paul Goldsmith-Pinkham

Narratives: The Impact of Political Storytelling on Attitudes Towards Migration

joint with Johannes Matzat

Teaching Experience

University of Mannheim

Teaching Assistant

Statistics II (*scheduled*)

Fall 2026

Econometrics I (PhD-level), Prof. Christoph Rothe

Fall 2025

Introduction to Econometrics, Prof. Carsten Trenkler

Spring 2024

Introduction to Econometrics, Prof. Carsten Trenkler

Spring 2023

Statistics II

Fall 2022

Humboldt University of Berlin

Teaching Assistant

Macroeconomics I, Prof. Lutz Weinke

Fall 2020

Macroeconomics II, Prof. Michael Burda

Spring 2020

Macroeconomics I, Prof. Michael Burda

Fall 2019

Conferences and Seminars

2026

NASM of the Econometric Society, Emory University (*scheduled*)

ENTER Seminar, UCL

2025

CIML Training Conference: Frontiers of Causal Inference and Machine Learning, IMT Lucca

Econometrics Lunch, Brown University

Econometrics Prospectus Lunch, Yale University

2024

Bonn-Mannheim-Munich Workshop in Microeconometrics, Mannheim

Workshop on Networks and Political Economy, Sorbonne

CDSE Seminar, Mannheim

Econometrics Research Seminar, Mannheim

Econometrics Prospectus Lunch, Yale University

2023

CDSE Seminar, Mannheim

Econometrics Research Seminar, Mannheim

2022

FHM+ Workshop on Development Economics, Heidelberg

Other Professional Experience

Research Assistance

Prof. Christoph Rothe, University of Mannheim	<i>2023 – 2024</i>
Prof. Michael Burda, Humboldt University of Berlin	<i>2020 – 2021</i>
Prof. Alexander Stomper, Humboldt University of Berlin	<i>2018 – 2019</i>

Miscellaneous

Programming	R, Python, Java
Software	LaTeX, Zotero
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Spanish and Italian (beginner)

Awards and Distinctions

CDSE Scholarship – University of Mannheim	<i>2026 – 2027</i>
CDSE Scholarship – University of Mannheim	<i>2021 – 2023</i>
Studienförderung der Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung	<i>2017 – 2021</i>

Government-funded scholarship granted for academic excellence and social engagement.

Portfolio Management Program – P & K Pühringer Foundation, ESMT and HU Berlin	<i>2018 – 2020</i>
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Group-based active portfolio management; certificate and grant for excellent performance. Mentor: Dr. Gerald Leitner.